ENTERPRISE POLICY DOCUMENT

ApexGlobal Technologies Policy Handbook

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Executive Summary: This handbook defines the operating guidelines, IT infrastructure policies, hardware provisioning rules, and security obligations for all employees of ApexGlobal Technologies Inc. Adherence to these standards is mandatory to protect company intellectual property and guarantee business continuity.

1. Organization Overview & Mission

ApexGlobal Technologies Inc. provides mission-critical cloud solutions and enterprise telemetry systems to global customers. Maintaining operational compliance, information security, and seamless support services is core to our corporate mission. Every ApexGlobal team member plays a direct role in maintaining data integrity and network hygiene.

2. IT Governance Structure

The ApexGlobal IT Support & Operations Group oversees all corporate hardware, cloud instances, communication channels, and identity management systems. The Apex Helpdesk serves as the single point of contact (SPOC) for operational support, access management, and incident escalation.

Tier / Group	Responsibilities	SLA Support Window
Tier 1 Support	Password resets, MFA sync, standard software setup, workstation diagnostics	24/7 Apex Helpdesk (Immediate)
Tier 2 Operations	Network troubleshooting, hardware replacement, VPN gateway configuration	4-hour Resolution SLA
Tier 3 Engineering	Cloud infrastructure, identity system architecture, security incident response	1-hour Urgent Response SLA

3. General Employee Conduct & Equipment Rules

All corporate hardware issued by ApexGlobal Technologies—including laptops, mobile phones, security keys, and accessories—remains company property. Hardware must be handled responsibly and protected from physical damage, unauthorized access, or loss.

- **Personal Use:** Corporate devices are assigned primarily for ApexGlobal business purposes. Minimal, responsible personal use is permitted provided it does not violate security rules.
- **Hardware Modifications:** Employees may not open device cases, replace internal hardware components, or alter firmware settings without Tier 3 IT authorization.
- **Asset Tagging:** Hardware asset labels must not be removed, altered, or covered. Missing asset tags must be reported to IT Asset Management immediately.

SECTION 2

Identity & Access Management (IAM)

Classification: Internal Confidential

4. Authentication & Password Requirements

ApexGlobal corporate accounts grant access to internal databases, proprietary code, and customer records. Strong authentication controls prevent credential theft and unauthorized entry into corporate systems.

Password Complexity Standards

- **Minimum Length:** Passwords must contain a minimum of 16 characters.
- **Character Sets:** Must include uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and special symbols (e.g., !@#$%^&*).
- **Expiration:** Service account passwords expire every 90 days. User accounts require updates upon credential exposure detection.
- **Re-use Restrictions:** Password history enforces a 12-generation restriction—previous passwords cannot be reused.

5. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) Protocol

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) is mandatory for all employee accounts accessing corporate email, internal portals, VPN gateways, and cloud applications. Password-only logins are permanently disabled across all ApexGlobal tenant domain accounts.

> **Approved Authentication Methods:** Employees must use hardware FIDO2 keys (YubiKey) or time-based one-time password (TOTP) authenticator applications (e.g., Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator). SMS/Text-message based MFA is prohibited due to SIM-swapping vulnerabilities.

6. User Access Rights & Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

Access privileges are granted strictly on the Principle of Least Privilege (PoLP). Employees are granted access only to resources required to complete their designated job responsibilities.

Access Tier	Privilege Level	Approval Requirement
Standard User	SaaS productivity tools, company intranet, personal email	Automatic upon HR onboarding
Elevated User	Departmental databases, shared cloud storage drives	Direct Manager approval
Administrative	Domain controllers, production databases, network infrastructure	Department Head + CISO written sign-off

7. Offboarding & Access Revocation

Upon notification of employee resignation or separation, HR and IT execute immediate access revocation workflows. All corporate account access is terminated within 30 minutes of official departure time, and issued physical assets must be returned to IT Ops within 5 business days.

SECTION 3

Network Security & Remote Access

Classification: Internal Confidential

8. Secure Virtual Private Network (VPN) Usage

Remote and hybrid employees connecting to internal company networks, file servers, or staging environments must establish an encrypted connection using the ApexGlobal VPN client. Connecting directly to internal services over unsecured public Wi-Fi is strictly prohibited.

VPN Connection Steps

1. Launch the approved corporate VPN client on your issued ApexGlobal laptop.
2. Select the geographically closest gateway server (e.g., `us-east.vpn.apexglobal.com`).
3. Authenticate using your corporate SSO username, primary password, and secondary MFA prompt.
4. Ensure the network status indicator confirms *"Encrypted Tunnel Established"* before accessing internal tooling.

9. Remote Work Environment Standards

Employees operating remotely must maintain physical security controls equivalent to ApexGlobal office spaces. Devices left unattended must be locked to prevent unauthorized viewing by third parties or family members.

> **Screen Lock Enforcement:** Corporate workstations automatically engage a password-protected screen lock after 5 minutes of inactivity. Attempting to bypass screen lock timers with hardware jigs or software keep-awake utilities is a direct policy violation.

10. Public Wi-Fi & Travel Guidelines

When traveling or working from public locations such as hotels, coffee shops, or airports, staff must follow heightened security protocols to prevent interception of unencrypted traffic.

Location Type	Permitted Connection	Mandatory Control
Corporate Office	Secure Enterprise Wi-Fi (Apex-Enterprise)	802.1X Device Certificate Authentication
Home Office	WPA2/WPA3 Protected Router	Full Disk Encryption + Always-On VPN
Public Hotspot	Cellular Tethering or Public Wi-Fi	Mandatory ApexGlobal VPN Client Enforcement

SECTION 4

Data Protection & Software Management

Classification: Internal Confidential

11. Data Classification Framework

All information created, stored, or processed within ApexGlobal systems must be classified into one of four sensitivity categories. Correct classification dictates how data is encrypted, stored, and shared.

Level	Classification	Examples	Handling Requirements
Public	Public Information	Press releases, marketing material, open web content	No encryption required
Internal	Internal Business Data	Org charts, internal announcements, policy docs	Restricted to employees
Confidential	Customer & Financial	PII, customer databases, revenue reports	Encrypted at rest & in transit
Restricted	Proprietary IP	Source code, cryptographic keys, M&A files	CISO authorization + mandatory audit log

12. Software Installation & Anti-Malware Safeguards

Employees are prohibited from installing unapproved third-party software, browser extensions, or peer-to-peer applications on ApexGlobal devices. Unsanctioned software introduces software supply chain risks and potential licensing violations.

- **Approved Software Catalog:** All approved applications are deployed via the internal Apex App Store portal.
- **Endpoint Detection & Response (EDR):** All laptops run managed agent software. Attempts to disable or tamper with EDR processes trigger automatic system isolation.
- **Removable Media:** USB storage drives and external hard drives are disabled by default. Exceptions require temporary approval from IT Security.

13. Cloud Storage & Collaboration Tooling

Corporate documents must be stored exclusively in designated cloud repositories (e.g., Enterprise SharePoint, Google Drive for ApexGlobal). Using personal cloud accounts for company documents constitutes unauthorized data exfiltration.

SECTION 5

Incident Management & Cybersecurity

Classification: Internal Confidential

14. Cybersecurity Incident Reporting Protocol

Timely identification and containment of potential security incidents is critical. Any suspected malware infection, phishing attempt, lost laptop, or unauthorized access attempt must be reported to ApexGlobal Security Operations immediately.

> **Emergency Incident Hotline:** Email `security@apexglobal.com` or submit an urgent ticket via the internal Helpdesk portal. Reports can be submitted anonymously without risk of disciplinary action for accidental lapses.

15. Incident Severity Classification & Escalation

Upon receiving an incident report, Security Operations triage engineers classify the event severity level and execute containment playbooks.

Severity	Impact Description	Target Resolution
SEV-1 (Critical)	Active breach, ransomware outbreak, core infrastructure outage	Continuous escalation (Immediate response)
SEV-2 (High)	Single server compromise, lost device containing confidential data	Under 2 hours
SEV-3 (Moderate)	Isolated phishing report, unconfirmed credential anomaly	Under 8 hours
SEV-4 (Low)	Policy inquiry, minor software glitch, false positive alert	Within 24 business hours

16. Phishing Awareness & Social Engineering Training

Social engineering remains the primary attack vector targeting enterprise networks. All ApexGlobal personnel undergo mandatory annual security training and monthly simulated phishing exercises.

- Inspect sender email addresses carefully for domain typosquatting (e.g., `apex-gIobal.com` instead of `apexglobal.com`).
- Never click links or open attachments in unsolicited messages requesting urgent action or password validation.
- Use the "**Report Phishing**" button built into your email client to notify SOC analysts automatically.

SECTION 6

Compliance, Acknowledgment & Contact

Classification: Corporate Record

17. Policy Enforcement & Disciplinary Framework

Compliance with this handbook is a condition of employment at ApexGlobal Technologies. Failure to adhere to these policies may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment, revocation of access credentials, and legal prosecution where applicable.

18. Frequently Asked Support Contacts

Department	Contact Channel	Scope of Support
IT Service Desk	`it-support@apexglobal.com` | Ext: 4357	General hardware, VPN, MFA, software requests
Security Operations (SOC)	`security@apexglobal.com` | Ext: 9110	Phishing reports, lost devices, security alerts
Human Resources	`hr@apexglobal.com` | Ext: 2200	Onboarding, offboarding, policy clarifications
Facilities & Physical Security	`facilities@apexglobal.com` | Ext: 1120	Building access badges, keycards, visitor passes

19. Employee Acknowledgment Form

Please read the following statement carefully, complete the requested fields, and return the signed form to HR Personnel during onboarding.

I hereby acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the **ApexGlobal Technologies Policy Handbook**. I agree to abide by all rules, security standards, and operational guidelines detailed herein. I understand that failure to comply with these policies may lead to disciplinary measures.

Employee Printed Name	**Employee Signature**
Date	**Employee ID**